Ben Lovell

Software Developer

Hi, I'm Ben, an experienced Senior Software Engineer with a **proven track record** of delivering **high impact projects**, enhancing workflows, and **fostering technical expertise** in fast paced software development environments.

LINKS

Email ben@lovell.io
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SKILLS

Fluent: Clojure & ClojureScript • Python • Backend Architecture • Dev Tooling • PostgreSQL • Infrastructure • Data Intensive engineering • Microservice design (REST + async) • Functional programming / immutable data mindset • CI/CD

Proficient: Infrastructure as code • Rust • Compilers/Parsers & DSLs • Kubernetes • Ruby (+ Ruby on Rails) • TypeScript/JavaScript • React • Nix • Docker • Cassandra • Kafka

Familiar: Scala • Go • HTML/CSS • MongoDB

EXPERIENCE

Present Day ↑ June 2025

Senior Software Engineer - **Tower**

Berlin, Germany

Contributed to CLI tooling, backend infrastructure, and developer experience for Tower's serverless Python platform. Core contributor across the Rust CLI, Go/Rust/TypeScript monorepo, and infrastructure:

- **redesigned** the runner event loop as an observe-decide-act state machine, with the decision step a pure function and all IO at the edges, making run behaviour deterministic and unit testable
- **improved** the resilience of customer jobs through deployment rollouts and transient failures
- **designed** and built the Organizations multi-tenancy system, from database to billing, so customers can give each of their users an isolated account under one umbrella
- **implemented** metrics, dashboards, and distributed tracing in Grafana Cloud, making run failures traceable across every service boundary
- **built** an MCP server into the Rust CLI and a Claude Code plugin on top of it, proving critical for adoption

Rust ◇ Go ◇ TypeScript/React ◇ Kubernetes ◇ Terraform ◇ PostgreSQL & Redis ◇ Nix

June 2025 ↑ September 2024

Freelancer & Open Source - **Self Employment**

Berlin, Germany

Took time between roles for contract work and open source contributions.

- **helped** design and implement a dependency injection framework in Rust for a client
- **contributed** packages to NixOS
- **worked** on some small projects for a Clojure TUI, incident response management, clojure.berlin

Rust ◇ Nix ◇ Clojure/Babashka ◇ Terraform

April 2024
↑
January 2019

Senior Software Engineer - **Pitch Software GmbH**

Berlin, Germany

Five years of production Clojure and ClojureScript across 4 product areas of Pitch's backend and frontend, specializing in the offline-first sync system:

- **designed** improvements to the core Clojure sync system to address data loss and convergence bugs under concurrent edits, shaping a long-term roadmap with senior leadership
- **fixed** uncontrollable image auto-cropping on the canvas in a self-led project, winning buy-in from the CTO and QA lead
- **mentored** junior engineers through their first feature implementations, and led a cross-team documentation working group
- **introduced** reproducible development environments with Nix and Docker, improving productivity across the engineering team

`Clojure/ClojureScript ◇ PostgreSQL ◇ Docker ◇ AWS ◇ TypeScript ◇ Nix`

December 2018
↑
March 2017

Backend Data Engineer - **Geeny/Telefónica Next GmbH**

Berlin, Germany

Hired as part of the full time expansion of the Geeny IoT Cloud platform from Telefónica Next GmbH, in order to build a data privacy first IoT solution I've:

- **architected** a microservices infrastructure on AWS with Docker, Kafka and HTTP/JSON
- **analysed** and translated product requirements into technical implementations
- **delivered** 3 crucial Clojure services under a month-long time constraint
- **led** the effort to have a 15-repo continuous integration and deployment process with GitLab CI/CD, reducing the release cycle from weeks to minutes

`Scala ◇ Clojure ◇ Kafka ◇ Postgres ◇ Docker ◇ AWS ◇ Kubernetes ◇ Protobufs`

Red Pineapple Media GmbH Software Engineer *April 2015 – February 2017*
I was brought on to help with the urgent rewrite of the video ad delivery system from PHP using a modern Clojure stack. Key role in system design and performance.

`Clojure ◇ MySQL ◇ Cassandra ◇ OpenRTB ◇ Gatling ◇ AWS`

lifelife UG Full Stack Developer *November 2014 – April 2015*
Created a decoupled separate service to interact with the main Rails application. Implemented funnel metrics, multiple locale support, and more.

`Ruby on Rails ◇ Sinatra`

Skyscanner Ltd Intern at Change the Market (R&D) *June 2013 – August 2013*
Built a better R&D frontend interface by writing a small DSL & parser (in JavaScript).

`Parser/Compiler writing ◇ Python`

University of St Andrews Research Intern *June 2012 – July 2012*
Created a population simulation tool for demographic and graph db testing.

EDUCATION

University of St Andrews 2.1, BSc (Hons) in Computer Science *2010 – 2014*
Heavy practical education with subjects including:
Data Encoding, Artificial Intelligence, Operating Systems, Computer Architecture, Knowledge Discovery and Datamining, Programming Language Design and Implementation (PLDI)

OUTSIDE RESPONSIBILITIES

Clojure Berlin Meetup Co-Organizer *October 2016 – Present*
Part of a small team taking turns to MC, filling in for lack of speakers, and keeping our 900 member meetup connected

ClojureBridge Berlin Orga Team Member and Coach *Summer 2015 – Summer 2017*
Conducted outreach, triaged attendee invitations, organized catering, etc.